

Barrier Breakers 2027

Financial Health Innovation Challenge



Cash Prizes + School Grants • Date & Host Campus Coming Soon

High schoolers in Northeast Ohio: build a solution to a real financial barrier, bring a poster, and pitch it to a panel of judges. Five teams go on to present to everyone.



Transportation



Housing



Healthcare



Financial Literacy



Your Own Idea

How It Works

- **RSVP as a team** (1-3 students)
- **Pick a barrier** from the list above, or bring your own. Nothing to declare.
- **Build a solution** — app, tool, policy, or resource. AI tools welcome.
- **Bring a poster and pitch it in 60 seconds** to three judges, then take questions
- **Five finalists** present to the whole room at Demo Day that afternoon

Why Bring Your Students

- Every team is judged by the same three-person panel as everyone in their section
- Real-world problem solving and a pitch they'll remember
- University campus visit opportunity
- Networking with business professionals
- Portfolio-building project for college apps

Prize Categories

Demo Day (5 Finalists)

Ranked 1st through 5th
Team cash + grant to your school

Honorable Mentions

Each section's runner-up
Recognized at the awards

Knowledge Track

Optional financial literacy quiz over lunch
Small cash prizes for the top scores

Ready to Participate?

No limit on teams — everyone who RSVPs competes. 2027 prize pool announced with sponsors; 2026 awarded \$20,000+.

Event
Details →

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Questions? Contact competition@finmango.org | finmango.org/barrier-breakers